appoint ap · point

Definition

verb

1. to name someone to a particular office or duty.

   The mayor appointed a new police chief.

Advanced Definition

transitive verb

1. to name to a particular office or function; designate.

   The broadcasting service appointed him news director.
   The president appointed a new ambassador to the United Nations.
   The sheriff appointed a deputy to look into the recent break-ins.

2. to set, fix, or determine by agreement or authority.

   Let's appoint a regular meeting time.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. 1981: Sandra Day O'Connor is the first woman justice appointed to the U.S. Supreme Court.
2. [U.S. Supreme Court Justices] are appointed by the president with the advice and approval of the Senate.
3. In 1997, Madeleine Albright was appointed the first woman Secretary of State. In 2005, Condoleezza Rice became the first African American woman to hold that office.
4. [State governors] sign bills into law, appoint judges and serve as the head of the Executive Branch of government in their state; the same way the president is in charge of the Executive Branch of the U.S. government.
5. In 1775, he was appointed the first Postmaster General of the American colonies. When he began the job, a letter traveling from New York to Philadelphia could take two weeks, even though the distance was only 109 miles.
6. In 1863 President Abraham Lincoln appointed a day of thanksgiving as the last Thursday in November, which he may have correlated with the November 21, 1621, anchoring of the Mayflower at Cape Cod. Since then, each president has issued a Thanksgiving Day proclamation.
7. The men who participated in the revolution, signed the Declaration of Independence, and contributed to drafting the Constitution are known as “founding fathers.” Benjamin Franklin, who is portrayed on the 100-dollar note, was one of the “Committee of Five” men who were appointed to draft the Declaration that was eventually signed by the other founding fathers.

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